

Awesome Motive Quarterly Review

Yazdan Ibrahim / Q4 2025

Position: Senior Video Content Creator

Team: Smash Balloon

Supervisor: Lianne Laroya

Key Performance Indicators

GENERAL	
Video Frequency	2
Video Quality	2
ROCKS	
At least 12 points of Individual KPIs	2
Webinars	1
WPChat Videos	2
TikTok and Instagram Reels Growth	1
Overall Score	2

Recap and Feedback

KPIs

Video Frequency

Self-Evaluation:

Please briefly share your reflections on how this KPI went. Questions to consider in your reflection: *What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?*

On average, I continued to publish two videos weekly across Smash Balloon and WPChat, with additional AIOSEO videos when needed. I was able to create three videos per week consistently for most of the quarter, with only a small number of weeks impacted by PTO, sick leave or admin-focused work. Managing video production across multiple brands and a newly launched product was challenging, but I maintained strong overall consistency. Toward the end of the quarter, I felt more confident balancing priorities and pacing my workload.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie “I shared a X score on this KPI because...”)

I gave myself a 2 here because I maintained consistent output throughout the quarter, met expectations, and adapted effectively when priorities shifted. I gave myself a strong score here because I maintained consistent output throughout the quarter, met expectations in most weeks, and adapted effectively when priorities shifted.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with your score of 2. Consistently publishing videos across Smash Balloon and WPChat during the launch was a major win. You effectively handled the heavy workload and ensured our main channel stayed active even while we were building up the new brand.

Video Quality

Self-Evaluation:

Please briefly share your reflections on how this KPI went. Questions to consider in your reflection: What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?

The quality of my videos improved this quarter through better tooling and presentation. Using Screen Studio for screen recordings helped elevate production quality with smoother animations and a cleaner visual style. I also appeared on camera more often where appropriate, which added a more human element and generally led to better-performing videos. Feedback throughout the quarter was clear and helpful, allowing me to continuously refine delivery, structure, and clarity. Next quarter, I want to further improve video hooks and early retention.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie “I shared a X score on this KPI because...”)

I rated myself a 2 for video quality because I made deliberate improvements to production value, presentation, and clarity while consistently applying feedback to future videos.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with your score of 2. The visual upgrades using Screen Studio made a noticeable difference in the polish of our tutorials, and your decision to appear on camera more often was a strategic win. Adding that human element builds trust with the Smash Balloon audience, which is essential for our brand authority.

Rocks

At least 12 points of Individual KPIs

Self-Evaluation

In 3-5 sentences, please summarize what you did for this Rock.

I created a mix of Marketable Moments videos, tutorials, and other video types that contributed to an overall average of approximately 11.5 points per week. I would have consistently hit the 12-point target if not for two 8-point weeks and one PTO week, and I am currently on track to reach 12 points in the final week of the quarter. I produced content across three different channels while learning new products and adapting to new workflows. Overall, I maintained strong consistency while balancing multiple brands and content formats.

Please briefly share your reflections on how this rock went. Questions to consider in your reflection: What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?

This Rock went well overall, as I was able to remain largely consistent despite reworks, a few sick days, and the learning curve associated with AIOSEO and WPChat. Balancing workload across multiple brands was challenging at first, but became more manageable over time. I learned how to better pace my work, adjust to product changes, and prioritize output during high-pressure periods. In future quarters, spreading out larger deliverables like webinars more evenly would help reduce end-of-quarter pressure.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie “I shared a X score on this Rock because...”)

I shared a score of 2 on this Rock because while I came very close to consistently meeting the 12-point target and delivered strong output across multiple channels, a small number of weeks fell short due to unavoidable circumstances and prioritization decisions.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with your score of 2 based on your consistency and volume. You successfully managed the workload across multiple brands and came very close to your weekly targets despite the context switching. From a production standpoint, you delivered what was asked.

However, we need to look at the results generated by that work. In Q3, our YouTube channel had 40,656 views and 744.7 hours of watch time. In Q4, despite the high output, this dropped to 32,083 views and 604.8 hours. This is a clear signal that while the output (points) is good, the outcome (views) is slipping. Hitting a 12-point target proves you can do the work, but for the next quarter, we must prioritize content topics that reverse this trend and drive those view counts back up.

Webinars

Self-Evaluation

In 3-5 sentences, please summarize what you did for this Rock.

I worked on two webinars this quarter focused on Instagram strategy and WPChat, selecting topics designed to help business owners close success gaps while naturally integrating our products. I drafted slides, and recorded one webinar which is nearly complete in editing, and a second webinar that is on track to be finished in the final week of the quarter along with its promotional emails. Although both webinars are not fully completed at the time of this review, I am on track to deliver them by quarter end.

Please briefly share your reflections on how this rock went. Questions to consider in your reflection: What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?

Webinars were pushed back this quarter as I prioritised WPChat and AIOSEO videos, along with required Marketable Moments content. I focused heavily on delivering high-value topics that would spark curiosity and encourage viewers to watch through to the end. Based on previous strong performance, the Instagram webinar topic was revisited and adjusted to better serve businesses aiming to grow local followers and customers. Webinar production is more time-intensive due to planning, slide creation, and a different editing workflow, but it is rewarding when the final output performs well.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie “I shared a X score on this Rock because...”)

I gave myself a score of 2 on this Rock because I am on track to complete two webinars and their associated promotional emails by the end of the quarter.

Supervisor Feedback

I am giving this a score of 1. While I agree that the topics you selected were strategic, the timing of the execution was a significant miss.

From a growth perspective, a webinar that is finished in the final week of the quarter yielded zero leads for the entirety of that quarter. Even with the heavy WPChat workload, we could have adjusted the plan to ensure at least one of these went live mid-quarter. Moving forward, we cannot treat these as just tasks to complete by the deadline; we need to prioritize shipping assets earlier so they can start generating outcomes throughout the quarter.

WPChat Videos

Self-Evaluation

In 3-5 sentences, please summarize what you did for this Rock.

This quarter, I created 18 WPC videos and published 12 so far, with a total of 20 expected by the end of the quarter once the WPChat webinar and upcoming MM video is completed. I worked across

announcements, tutorials, overviews, and feature-focused videos to support the launch of a brand-new product. This included helping establish a new WPChat YouTube channel and contributing to early growth and awareness. I focused on clearly presenting WPChat's features and use cases to help viewers understand the product's value.

Please briefly share your reflections on how this rock went. Questions to consider in your reflection: What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?

This Rock went very well and was enjoyable, as it gave me the opportunity to work on a new product and experiment with how best to present its features through video. Learning how to explain WPChat clearly and adjusting content as the product evolved was challenging but rewarding. Launching a new channel from scratch and seeing it gain early traction, currently at 9 subscribers, was motivating. Going forward, continuing to publish WPChat videos as collaboration posts with the main Smash Balloon channel will help increase discoverability and audience growth.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie "I shared a X score on this Rock because...")

I shared a score of 2 for this Rock because I focused heavily on WPChat throughout the quarter to support the product launch, consistently producing high-quality videos and helping build early momentum and awareness for the new product.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with the score of 2 regarding the volume of work produced. Delivering 18 videos to support the launch was a heavy lift, and you successfully ensured the product had a comprehensive content library from Day 1.

That being said, we have a "High Output / Low Outcome" gap. We produced 18 videos to reach 9 subscribers and 9 watch time (hours). We cannot afford to spend that much production time for such low visibility. To combat this, we need to validate our collaboration strategy with data.

For Q1, I want you to track the viewers and subscribers coming from our collaboration posts. We need to identify exactly which videos transfer authority from Smash Balloon to WPChat by tracking the number of subscribers gained from a specific collaboration video. Use tracking links or specific CTAs to measure this. If a collaboration video does not drive at least 3 new subscribers, we need to pivot the topic or the hook immediately. Track the subscriber lift per video weekly and we can discuss how to improve this metric during our 1:1 calls.

TikTok and Instagram Reels Growth

Self-Evaluation

In 3-5 sentences, please summarize what you did for this Rock.

The plan for this Rock was to create and implement a TikTok content strategy for Smash Balloon and WPChat. This quarter, I focused on evaluating and rebuilding the strategy rather than executing it. I

developed a revised TikTok content plan based on addressing success gaps for target users and positioning Smash Balloon as an authority on the platform. While the plan was not fully implemented this quarter, the groundwork has been laid for execution moving forward.

Please briefly share your reflections on how this rock went. Questions to consider in your reflection: What went well/badly? What was easy/difficult? What did I learn? What do I still need to learn more about? What could I have done better?

This Rock did not progress as originally intended, mainly due to competing priorities such as the WPChat launch, the addition of AIOSEO responsibilities, and the shutdown of ClickSocial, which required a rethink of previously planned topics. The revised plan focuses less on direct promotion and more on earning repeat viewers and followers through high-value content and a lower production quality approach. With a clearer workload balance now in place, I feel more confident implementing this strategy in the next quarter.

Please share your scoring reasoning (ie “I shared a X score on this Rock because...”)

I shared a score of 1 for this Rock because while the strategy was not fully executed this quarter, we have drafted a new strategy that better aligns with what we want to implement going forward.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with the score of 1. It is completely understandable that the WPChat launch and the ClickSocial changes took precedence this quarter. When priorities shift, something has to give, and paused execution here was a necessary trade-off. As we’ve discussed in our team standards, a 1 is not a failure but rather space to improve as we tackle challenges that haven’t been previously identified or communicated.

That being said, as we move forward, we want to shift from "planning mode" (output) to "testing mode" (outcome). A strategy document is a great start, but until we publish, we don't have real data to guide us. I like your idea of a "lower production quality" approach – that is exactly the right mindset for rapid growth.

As you manage multiple brands, we must ensure this doesn't lead to burnout. I'd like you to look at using AI to repurpose your existing long-form tutorials into TikToks to maximize your output without doubling your workload.

AI Adoption

Self-Evaluation

In 3-5 sentences, please summarize where you fit into the [AI Adoption Matrix](#) for your role:

This quarter, I continued using Descript as a core part of my pre-editing workflow, leveraging AI transcription, assisted retake removal, and voice enhancement to speed up video production. These tools helped me work more efficiently and supported my ability to consistently hit weekly output targets.

I also used ElevenLabs and my AI voice clone to correct small voiceover errors and make quick amendments without re-recording. Additionally, I explored new AI video tools and automation platforms to support future workflow improvements.

I currently place myself at the Capable level and actively transitioning toward Adaptive. AI is a core part of my daily workflow and is used consistently for scripting, research, titles, descriptions, tags, and thumbnail ideation across Smash Balloon, WPChat, and AIOSEO videos. I also use AI tools to analyze channel performance, identify topic opportunities, and support structured formats like Marketable Moments videos. While many workflows are already established, I am still in the process of documenting and systematizing them to reach a fully Adaptive level.

Please briefly share your reflections on how AI Adoption went for you. Questions to consider in your reflection: How did I implement AI? What did I learn?

Using AI in my workflow went well overall and meaningfully improved speed and flexibility, particularly during busy weeks. Descript and ElevenLabs were the most immediately useful tools, while newer AI video generators such as OpenAI Sora 2, Google Veo 3, and others were helpful for creating B-roll assets in Marketable Moments videos, even if they are not yet suitable for primary content. I also began testing automation tools like n8n and Make for video research and competitor analysis, though these are still in refinement. There is still more to learn around integrating AI tools more systematically rather than testing them ad hoc.

This quarter, I implemented AI across multiple stages of video production including topic research, scripting, optimization, pre-editing, and audio enhancement, which significantly improved efficiency and consistency. I learned how to better guide AI outputs through custom prompts and role-specific chats, allowing me to move faster while maintaining clarity and brand tone. I also experimented with automation, AI-generated visuals, and short-form repurposing tools to explore future scaling opportunities. Overall, AI has become an essential part of how I work, and I see clear potential to further systematize these workflows next quarter.

Supervisor Feedback

I agree with your assessment of being at the Capable level. Your use of tools like Descript for pre-editing and ElevenLabs for voice corrections demonstrates that AI is already a core part of your production process

To move from Capable to Adaptive, we need to shift from "using tools ad-hoc" to "building measurable systems." According to our matrix, an Adaptive workflow isn't just about using AI. It's about proving the efficiency gain. Here is how I want you to bridge that gap next quarter:

- You mentioned testing short-form tools. To hit the Adaptive level, I want to see you use AI to efficiently repurpose long-form tutorials into Shorts, aiming for the matrix benchmark of "producing 3-4x more short-form content from existing assets." This is how you solve the capacity issue you faced with the TikTok/Reels Rock.

- As we discussed "admin-focused work," I want you to start tracking exactly how much time tools like Descript or your custom prompts are shaving off your production cycle. This data will help us identify which tasks are still bottlenecks and where we can automate further.
- I'm glad you're using AI for titles and descriptions. In Q1, let's start documenting the wins: show me where an AI-generated hook or thumbnail idea led to a measurable increase in average view duration or CTR compared to our previous baseline.
- You mentioned exploring short-form repurposing tools. I'd like to see a consistent workflow that turns our long-form tutorials into TikToks or Reels automatically, ensuring we maintain brand authority without doubling your manual workload.

To move from Capable to Adaptive, we need to move your AI usage from a personal efficiency tool to a measurable business driver. I would like to see you begin tracking these efforts in a dedicated tracking sheet to outline where time was spent, your involvement (direct production or AI-tool used), and the specific growth goal being targeted.

I want you to discuss these data points and your progress in every 1:1, as the "Capable" skills of today will likely become the baseline expectations of tomorrow.

Significant Contributions

In addition to my core responsibilities and quarterly Rocks, I invested significant time in self-directed learning to continuously improve my skill set and overall value to the team. I actively studied YouTube storytelling, video hooks, audience retention, and content structure through courses and educational content, applying these learnings directly to tutorial, Marketable Moments, and webinar videos.

I also focused on learning and experimenting with AI-driven workflows, including AI automation tools, AI-assisted video creation, research, and optimization techniques, with the goal of improving efficiency and output quality. This ongoing self-learning has helped me adapt quickly to new products, platforms, and responsibilities, and positions me to continue contributing at a higher level as our video strategy and tooling evolve.

Supervisor Feedback

Your commitment to self-directed learning in YouTube storytelling is a strategic asset. However, as we move into 2026, I want to see you transition from "learning" to "deploying."

It is great that you are formalizing AI workflows. This is a major contribution to team stability. Your effort to reduce friction is exactly what we need to clear out the "admin" bottlenecks. In our 1:1s, I want you to discuss the results of your new storytelling techniques, specifically, how they are moving the needle on our Average View Duration (AVD). Let's quantify the impact of your learning.

Self Reflection

Top 3 (T3)	Bottom 3 (B3)
<i>WPChat Launch video content</i>	<i>Balancing priorities across multiple teams and content types</i>
<i>Achieving 3000 subscribers for Smash Balloon's YouTube channel</i>	<i>Some reworks on WPChat videos</i>
<i>Working on multiple brands/products</i>	<i>Not being able to publish short form videos/strategy</i>

What tasks do you find most time-consuming or repetitive in your daily/weekly routine? If you've tried/considered leveraging AI/automation in any of these tasks, please summarize.

Video editing continues to take the most time in my workflow, though I've shortened this significantly by using tools like Descript to speed up editing and retake removal. While AI helps reduce manual effort, videos still require hands-on polishing before they're ready to publish. For script writing and topic research, AI has made the process much faster and easier, especially for ideation and evaluation.

How would you rate your happiness in your current position and team?

I'm very happy in my current position and enjoy working with both the Smash Balloon team and my newer teammates on the AIOSEO team. I value the opportunity to showcase the hard work of my colleagues through video and highlight the quality of our products and features. I take responsibility in representing Awesome Motive and its brands on camera seriously, and I'm grateful for the trust and opportunity to do so.

What are your career goals and where do you see yourself in 12 months from now?

In the next 12 months, my goal is to continue growing as a video creator and strengthen my impact across Awesome Motive's brands, especially Smash Balloon. Being a video creator is something I genuinely care about, and I take pride in constantly trying to be better at my craft. I want my work to speak for itself through strong performance, clear storytelling, and visible quality. Alongside this, I'd like to continue developing my skills in content strategy and marketing so I can contribute more strategically to how our videos grow audiences and drive results.

Anything else you'd like to share?

I'm very grateful to be part of Awesome Motive and the Smash Balloon team. It's a privilege to contribute through work that aligns closely with my passion, and I appreciate the trust, support, and encouragement I receive from my teammates and managers. I'm committed to always giving my best to the company and look forward to continuing this momentum into a successful 2026.

Supervisor Feedback

It is good to see you identify your top three wins with clear, quantifiable outcomes, such as hitting the 3,000 subscriber milestone for Smash Balloon. Successfully launching the WPChat video content is a significant achievement, and you are correctly framing these results in terms of building brand authority and audience growth. This is the exact growth mindset we need to continue building on: focusing on the direct impact your work has on our market presence.

Your biggest challenge, balancing the overlap of high-volume production across multiple teams, is a key area for improvement. The solution to this is more automation. We need to push your AI adoption even further so you are delegating the "output" (the structural drafting and repetitive admin tasks) and focusing the majority of your time on strategy and outcome analysis. This includes refining your core messaging, analyzing video engagement and retention data, and identifying new ways to drive growth.

As our video expert, growth is a central part of your role in this evolving landscape. Progressing will require a shown effort into taking a more active stance in growth outcomes (like conversion and audience retention), rather than just content output (the number of videos produced). Let's use the automation tools we've discussed to bridge these gaps and ensure every video we publish is a measurable business driver.

Looking Ahead

What to expect in the next quarter and new Rocks go here. This will be completed by your Supervisor.

In the next quarter, I'm looking forward to continuing to build the WPChat YouTube channel by creating more targeted content that drives views, engagement, and subscriber growth. I'd also like to place a stronger focus on TikTok and short-form content, as I see a clear opportunity to apply what I've learned and demonstrate stronger performance in this area. For AIOSEO, I'm keen to continue adding value through video content wherever the team needs support and where my skills can have the most impact.

AI Adoption Goals

My goal for the next quarter is to move from Capable toward a higher level on the AI Adoption rubric by documenting my workflows, refining existing processes, and focusing on measurable improvements in efficiency and performance. I want to better systematize how I use AI for research, scripting, optimization, and repurposing so these workflows are repeatable, scalable, and easier to build upon over time.

Supervisor Feedback

Video Frequency

Moving forward, we need to evolve how we report on video performance. It is no longer enough to track output (e.g., "I published 12 videos"). We need to track impact, specifically regarding our pivot from being seen as a "social feed plugin" to a "trust and growth tool", and also tracking and internal efficiency.

Regarding the "admin-focused work," we need to quantify the bottleneck. In Q1, I want you to identify exactly where that time is going. If we can use AI to automate even 5 hours per month of that admin work, that is time we can reinvest into strategy and content experimentation. In our next 1:1, let's look at your time tracking to find those specific hours.

Target Metric: Eliminate 5 hours of admin work per month using AI

Success Criteria: Time-tracking shows reduced manual workload

External Growth: I want you to connect your video activity to tangible business metrics regarding our pivot from "social feed plugin" to "trust tool." In our 1:1s, you should be able to confidently state:

- "Because we positioned this video around 'Building Trust' instead of just 'Embedding Feeds,' we saw a 20% increase in YouTube Views from new audiences."
- "Because we targeted the high-intent keyword 'Social Proof,' we increased YouTube Watch Time by X hours, signaling deeper user interest."

Shift your tracking sheet to include Attribution columns. Don't just list the video title, list the specific business goal it was designed to influence (e.g., Traffic, Conversion, Education) and the result.

Target Metric: Increase YouTube views by 10% on Trust-framed videos vs Feature-framed

Success Criteria: Attribution sheet shows Trust content outperforms Feature content

Video Quality

"Quality" must be measured by retention, not just aesthetics. A high-production video doesn't help us if the user drops off. For the next quarter, we need to move from "better looking" to "better performing." I want us to track the retention rate at the 30-second mark. If we can improve that baseline by 5% using better hooks, we will know the production quality is actually driving business results.

Target Metric: Increase 30-second retention by 5% vs Q4 baseline

Success Criteria: YouTube analytics confirm higher early-stage retention

A/B test our hypothesis that "Growth Framing" outperforms "Technical Framing." I want to see reports that follow this logic:

TikTok & IG Reels: Use short-form video to rapidly A/B test our "Strategy for Growth."

- Example: "Because I ran a split test comparing 'How to add a feed' vs. 'How to make your site trustworthy,' TikTok Engagement increased by 15%, proving the 'Trust' angle resonates more."

Webinars: Experiment with the framing to drive higher attendance.

- Example: Because we titled the Webinar 'Increasing Sales with Social Proof' instead of 'Plugin Walkthrough,' we saw a 20% increase in Webinar Signups."

Target Metric: Execute 10 A/B split tests (using Short-form video hooks, YouTube Titles, or Webinar positioning) comparing "Technical/Feature" framing vs. "Trust/Growth" framing.

Success Criteria: Documented 5% increase in Engagement or Leads on the "Growth" variants (e.g., confirming that the "Trust" angle outperforms the "How-to" angle)

Your Rocks

- Webinars
 - Position topics around solving business pains rather than just features. This experimental approach to framing is the key to unlocking higher attendance, resulting in increased Webinar Signups and deeper funnel impact.
 - Target Metric: Publish 2 high-value webinars by Week 6 of Q1 (mid-quarter) to ensure run-time for lead generation.
 - Success Criteria: Generate 50+ qualified signups per webinar attributed directly to the webinar funnel by the end of Q1.
- WPChat YouTube Videos
 - Target Metric: Reach 50 subscribers and 30 watch time by end of Q1.
 - Success Criteria: 0.50% of WPChat site traffic originates from YouTube.
- Video Content Growth
 - Strategy for growth
 - Target Metric: Establish a consistent publishing cadence of 3 Short-Form videos per week across TikTok and Reels.
 - Success Criteria: Achieve a baseline Average View Count of 400 per video by the end of Q1.
 - TikTok and IG Reels
 - Target Metric: Drive 100 tracked clicks from social bio links (TikTok/Instagram) to specific Smash Balloon landing pages.
 - Success Criteria: Documented evidence that short-form content is not just building "vanity metrics" (views) but is actively moving users into our marketing funnel.

AI Adoption Goals

Select a specific goal from the "Adaptive" level of our AI framework, one that aligns directly with your growth and video strategy, and show consistent progress on it throughout Q1.

Instead of only using AI to generate scripts or assets, I want you to push into automation and risk detection. This includes using AI to analyze our current content strategy, identify "failure points" in our messaging, and research competitor trends to find new growth opportunities.

Pick a consistent system to quantify your progress. This could be Time Savings (e.g., "Using a custom GPT reduced my research and drafting time by X hours per week") or Content Performance (e.g., "AI-optimized hooks increased our TikTok retention by Y%"), etc.

We will make this a standing item in our 1:1s. Be prepared to share your initial data points and explain how you are iterating on your AI workflows to drive better outcomes for Smash Balloon and WPChat.

KPI Scoring

Below is a breakdown of KPI scores and what each number means.

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
N/A	You were not able to start. <i>Work did not start due to external factors or was postponed by the manager.</i>
0	You encountered significant problems. <i>Work had critical issues, or did not meet any expectations</i>
1	You have room for growth and/or areas that can be improved. <i>Work needed changes, didn't meet all expectations, or wasn't fully completed.</i>
2	You did a great job and met our very high expectations. <i>Work was solid and on point.</i>
3	You crushed it and exceeded our very high expectations. <i>Work went above and beyond the call of duty.</i>
4	You made the needle move. <i>Work impacted or transformed the business in a measurable way.</i>